

GRAPHS USING OPEN FLASH CHARTS

Part—3

In the earlier parts of this series, we looked at using Open Flash Charts (OFC) to create great-looking bar charts and pie charts. In this part, let us look at how to create line charts and draw multiple line charts in the same graph, which shows even more data in a very effective manner.

As always, let us first define our data for the graph. For our line chart, let us take a classroom scenario. For each subject, we have the total number of students that appeared, and the number of students that get a first class, as shown in the table below. Let us plot this data as multiple line charts—one line showing the total number of students and the second the number of students getting a first class.

Subject	Total number of students	Total number with a first class
Physics	100	30
Mathematics	70	40
English	50	40
Chemistry	60	50

Get going

I assume that the data is already stored in a MySQL database, and will proceed straight to the data file (with the SQL query to fetch data to be plotted, you can proceed to format it and pass it on to OFC to render the graph). The data file to draw the line chart for our example is as follows:

```
<?php
$die = false;
$link = @mysql_connect('localhost','test_user','test_pwd') or
($die = true);
if($die)
{
    echo '<h3>Database connection error!!!</h3>';
    echo 'A connection to the Database could not be
```

```
established.<br />';
    echo 'Please check your username, password, database name and
host.<br />';
    echo 'Also make sure <i>mysql.class.php</i> is rightly
configured!<br /><br />';
}
mysql_select_db('test_database');
include_once 'php-ofc-library/open-flash-chart.php';
$query = mysql_query('SELECT DISTINCT Subject, Total_Students,
Total_First_Class Number FROM test_linechart');
while($queryRow = mysql_fetch_array($query, MYSQL_ASSOC))
{
    $labels[] = $queryRow['Subject'];
    $data_1[] = intval($queryRow['Total_Students']);
    $data_2[] = intval($queryRow['Number']);
}

$default_dot = new dot();
$default_dot->size(5)->colour('#DFC329');

$line_dot = new line();
$line_dot->set_default_dot_style($default_dot);
$line_dot->set_width( 4 );
$line_dot->set_colour( 'DFC329' );
$line_dot->set_values( $data_1 );
$line_dot->set_key( "Students Appearing", 10 );

$default_hollow_dot = new hollow_dot();
$default_hollow_dot->size(5)->colour('#6363AC');

$line_hollow = new line();
```